全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 41 單元 | 動作與移動 · Actions & Movement

The Night the Lights Went Out

燈熄滅的那一夜

Last Friday, a typhoon was pouring rain over Taipei when the lights in our cram school suddenly went out. Everything halted. For a second, nobody reacted; we just sat in the dark and gazed at the black screen where the teacher's slides had been. Then a few students giggled nervously, and someone whispered, "Is this a test?" Mr. Lin, who never seems to panic, told us to hush and to stay in our seats so that nobody would trip and get hurt.

Since the emergency light overhead only gave a weak glow, Mr. Lin grabbed his phone and switched on the flashlight. Light flashed across the ceiling, and I caught a glimpse of my friend Wen-hao pretending to be a ghost, which made the girls behind us leap out of their chairs. Mr. Lin glanced at him and simply patted him on the shoulder. "Nice try," he said with a grin. Then he asked me to fetch the candles that were kept in the drawer at the back of the room. I had to kneel on the floor and peer into the dark drawer, but I finally located them.

What happened next was the best part of the evening. Instead of proceeding with the grammar lesson, Mr. Lin leaned against the desk and began to hum an old song, and the whole class joined in. Shadows floated on the walls as the candle flames danced. Nobody wanted to flee into the storm, so we told stories and laughed until the power came back. When it did, a few students actually groaned, and Wen-hao gave the candle a hug as if it were an old friend. I had always thought a blackout would be frightening, but that night, the darkness seemed to melt the usual distance between a teacher and his students.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
halt	*v.*	停止；停下	The train halted at the small station for only one minute. 火車在小站只停了一分鐘。
gaze	*v.*	凝視；注視	She gazed at the stars until she fell asleep. 她凝視著星星，直到睡著。
giggle	*v.*	咯咯笑	The children giggled when the clown fell down. 小丑跌倒時，孩子們咯咯地笑了。

hush	*v.*	（使）安靜	The mother hushed the baby with a soft song. 媽媽用輕柔的歌聲讓寶寶安靜下來。
glow	*n.*	微光；光輝	The glow of the sunset turned the river gold. 夕陽的光輝把河水染成金色。
glimpse	*n.*	一瞥；一眼	We caught a glimpse of the singer as she left the hotel. 歌手離開飯店時，我們瞥見了她一眼。
grin	*n.*	露齒的笑	He answered with a big grin on his face. 他回答時臉上帶著大大的笑容。
fetch	*v.*	去拿來；取來	Could you fetch me the dictionary from the shelf? 你可以幫我從書架上拿字典來嗎？
kneel	*v.*	跪下	The old man knelt down to pick up the coin. 老人跪下來撿硬幣。
lean	*v.*	倚靠；傾斜	Don't lean against the door; it is not locked. 不要靠在門上，門沒有鎖。

片語 Phrases

catch a glimpse of	瞥見；看到一眼	I caught a glimpse of a deer in the forest. 我在森林裡瞥見一隻鹿。
lean against	靠著	The bike was leaning against the wall. 腳踏車靠在牆邊。
join in	加入；一起參與	Everyone joined in when the band played the last song. 樂團演奏最後一首歌時，大家都加入了。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + V ... so that + S + would / could + V

so that 引導目的副詞子句，表示「以便…、為了讓…」，子句中常搭配 would、could、can 等助動詞。

Mr. Lin told us to stay in our seats so that nobody would trip.

林老師叫我們待在座位上，免得有人絆倒。

S＋V＋as if＋S＋were / 過去式

as if 後接過去式（be 動詞用 were）表示與事實相反的假設，意思是「彷彿…、好像…」。

He hugged the candle as if it were an old friend.

他抱著蠟燭，好像它是老朋友一樣。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。